

# Alexandra Sandström

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*Research Interests:* Political Economy, Economic History, Development Economics, Economics of Education

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## CURRENT POSITION

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**Uppsala University**, Department of Economics (Uppsala, Sweden)

*Aug. 2022–Jun. 2027 (expected)*

**Ph.D. Candidate in Economics**

*Main Advisor:* Luca Repetto

*Secondary Advisor:* Eva Mörk

*Affiliations:* Uppsala Immigration Lab (UIL), Uppsala History of Inequality and Labor Lab (UHILL)

## VISITING POSITION

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**Harvard University** (Cambridge, MA, USA)

*Spring 2025*

Visiting Fellow, Harvard Business School

*Host:* Marco Tabellini

## PREVIOUS EDUCATION

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**Ludwig Maximilian University** (Munich, Germany)

*2019–2021*

MSc in Economics

**Umeå University** (Umeå, Sweden)

*2016–2019*

MSc in Governance and Administration

**Sabanci University** (Istanbul, Turkey)

*Spring 2018*

Visiting Student

## WORKING PAPERS

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### Language of Instruction, Integration, and Identity: Evidence from Sweden's Tornedalians (JMP)

*Abstract:* How does language of instruction shape social integration and national identity? I study the introduction of primary schools with Swedish, rather than Finnish, as the language of instruction in late nineteenth-century Tornedalen, a predominantly Finnish-speaking region of Sweden bordering Finland. Using linked censuses and variation across villages and cohorts, I estimate the effects of exposure to Swedish-only schooling. Exposure increased integration, as reflected in marriage patterns and reduced ethnic residential segregation, while shifting identity away from Swedish and toward Finnish, as measured by naming choices and military employment. These results suggest that social integration need not imply cultural assimilation. I find no effects on income, education beyond primary school, or language use at home. The evidence is consistent with school interactions promoting integration, while Swedish-only instruction increased the salience of language as an ethnic attribute and reduced perceived distance to Finns across the border, thereby altering social identity. At the village level, school openings were followed by a shift toward Swedish naming and declining Finnish language use at home, highlighting how nation-building through education can have different effects through direct exposure to schooling and the broader consequences of school openings.

### The State Made War, and War Made the Rebels: WWI Mortality and Irish Independence

*with F. Carozzi and L. Repetto*

*Abstract:* Can the human costs of fighting for a state spur later participation in rebellion against it? We study this question in Ireland, where communities sent men to fight for Britain in World War I and soon after supplied rebels in the War of Independence. We instrument local death rates using a shift-share instrument that uses as exogenous shifts the mortality of the regiments in which recruits served. In our preferred specification, a one-standard-deviation increase in the WWI death rate raises the rebel rate by about 1.5 additional rebels per 100 inhabitants, relative to a sample mean of 1.4. The same pattern appears for contemporaneous donations to republican aid organisations. These effects are larger in Catholic and culturally Irish regions and are absent in predominantly Protestant Northern Ireland. The results suggest that the human costs of warfare deepened anti-imperial grievances and raised the local supply of rebel effort where pre-existing identity cleavages made independence a salient alternative to continued attachment to Britain.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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### First Language Training and Integration

*with S. Strömberg*

### Nationalist Organizations, Cultural Revival, and Political Mobilization: The Gaelic League in Ireland

*with F. Carozzi and L. Repetto*

## PUBLICATIONS

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Berggren, Niclas, Christian Bjørnskov, and Alexandra Sandström (2026). The Rule of Law Predicts Trust in Journalists. *Journal of Law and Economics*, 69(2), 361–385.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### Uppsala University

**Development Economics** (BSc level), *Lecturer and Teaching Assistant* 2023–2024

**Macroeconomics** (BSc level), *Teaching Assistant* 2023–2026

**Fundamentals of Environmental Economics** (MSc level), *Teaching Assistant* Fall 2024

## PAST EMPLOYMENT

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**Research Institute of Industrial Economics** (Stockholm, Sweden) Oct. 2021–Aug. 2022  
Research Assistant

**Max Planck Institute** (Munich, Germany) Jan. 2020–Sep. 2021  
Part-time Research Assistant, Institute for Social Law and Social Policy

## GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

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### Jan Wallander and Tom Hedelius Foundation

Hedelius Scholarship for doctoral studies abroad, 295,000 SEK 2024

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

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**Organizer**, Uppsala University, Department of Economics, Graduate Student Brownbag Seminar Series 2024

**Board Member**, Uppsala University, Department of Economics, PhD Association 2023–2024

## SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

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**2026:** Uppsala History of Inequality and Labor Lab (UHILL) Workshop; Economic History Society Annual Conference; Stockholm–Uppsala Education Economics Workshop; Uppsala Economic History Workshop; Nordic Conference in Development Economics; EEA Congress

**2025:** Harvard Graduate Student Workshop in Economic History; Center for European Studies Harvard Ph.D. and Postdoctoral Conference on European Development; Political Economy of Conflict and Redistribution Summer School; ASREC Europe Graduate Student Workshop

**2024:** Uppsala University Department of Peace and Conflict Research Brownbag; Association of Swedish Development Economists Conference